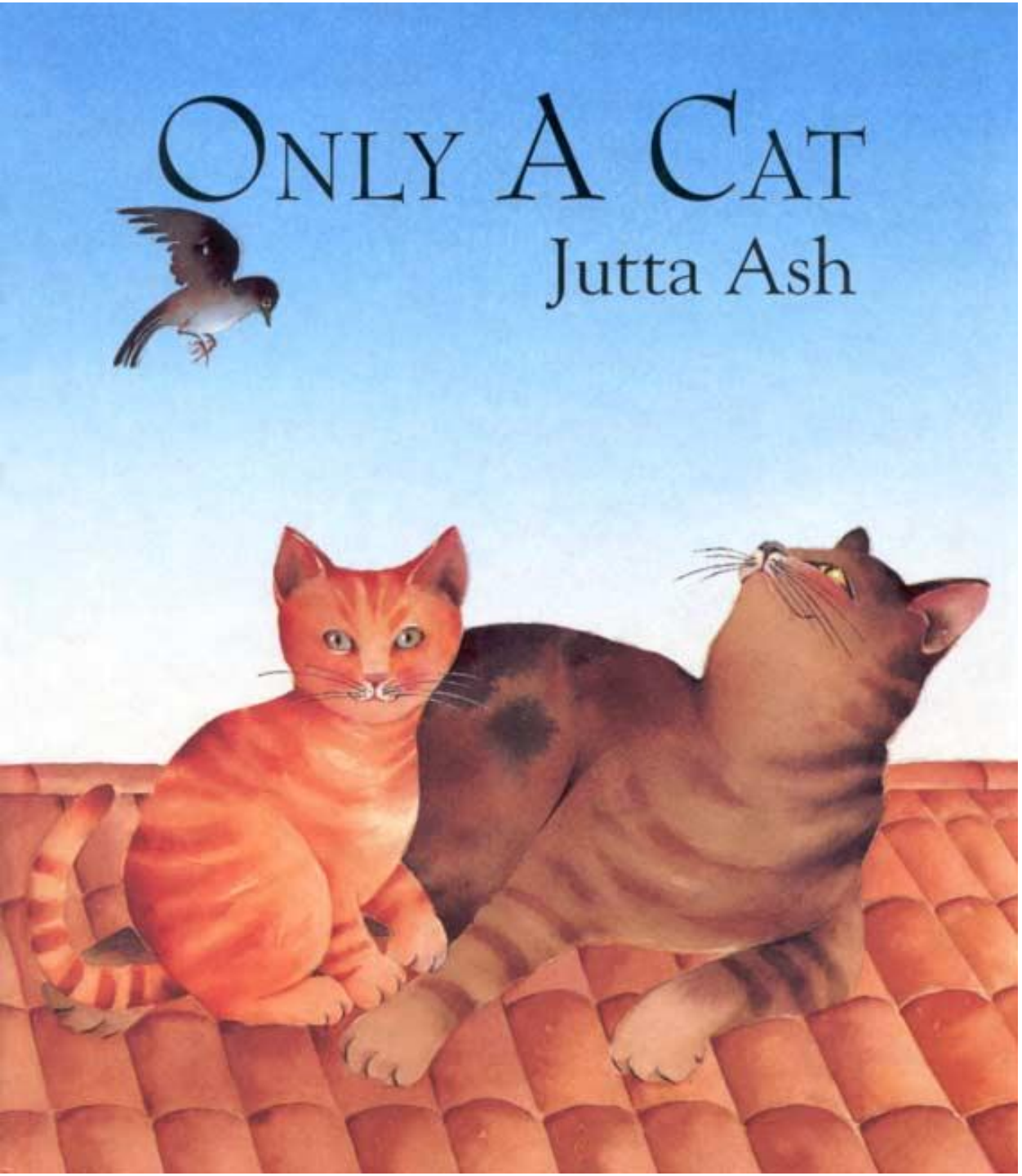


Day 47

Only A Cat

Jutta Ash

一只活泼可爱的小猫咪。平日里，她对任何没有做过的事情都抱有一颗想尝试的心。哪怕要吃苦头，也阻止不了她探索新事物的脚步。这次她又有哪些新的尝试呢？

Kitten-Cat's mother was dozing so Kitten-Cat
played with her tail . . .
and played with her tail . . .

and climbed on to the washing line to try some flying.

"Whoops!" laughed the birds.
"Hasn't anyone told you? Cats can't fly."

So Kitten-Cat picked herself up, smoothed herself down
and went to try some nut-cracking.

"Oh dear, oh dear!" chuckled the squirrels.
"Haven't you noticed? Cats can't crack nuts."

So Kitten-Cat put her nose in the air and slipped down
to the stream to try some hopping.

"Silly billy!" croaked the frogs.
"Look at yourself! You're a cat and cats can't hop."

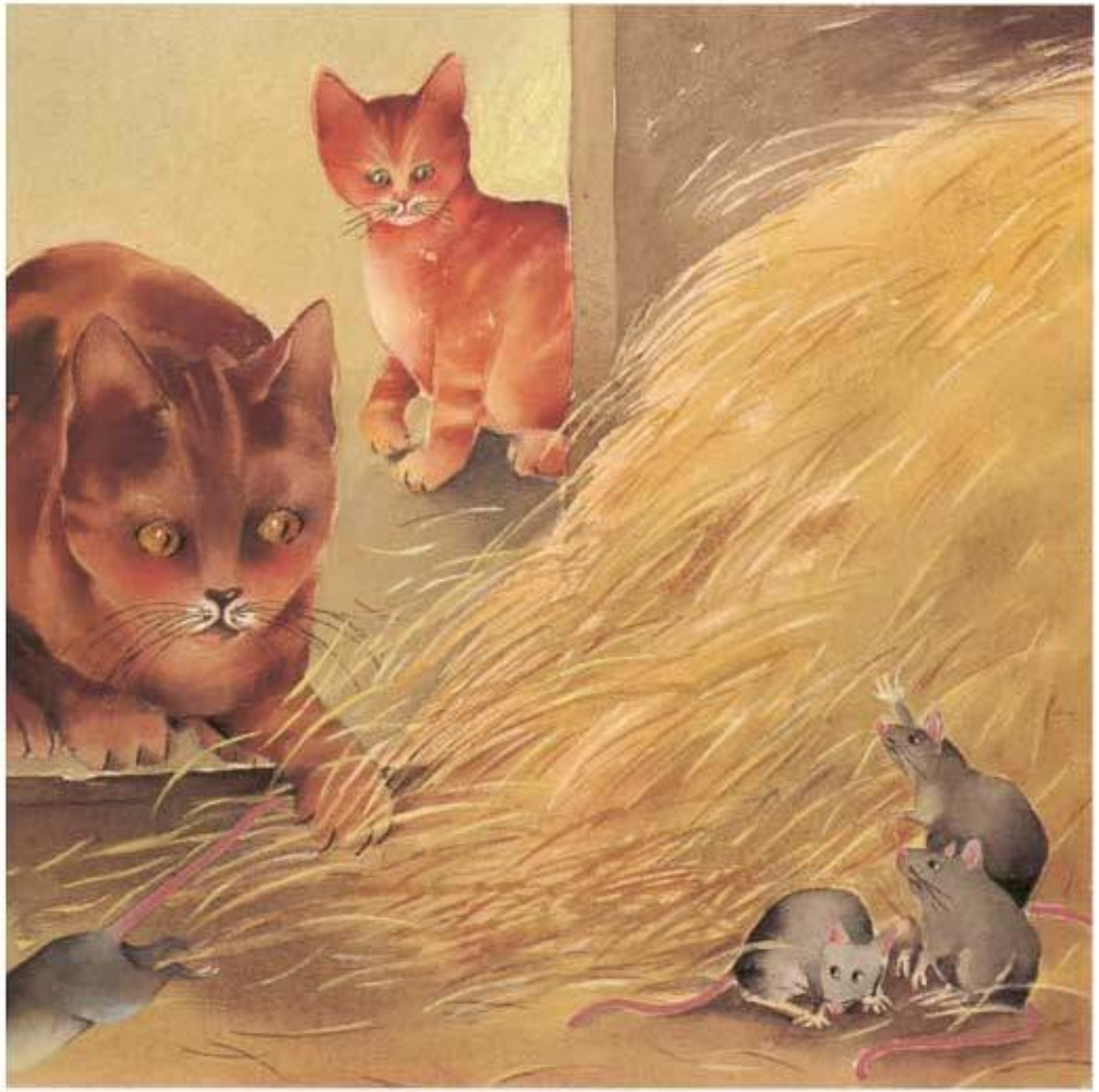
So Kitten-Cat shook the mud from her paws and strolled over to the henhouse to try some crowing.

"Nonsense and ridiculous!" said the cockerel.
"Cockerels crow, not cats. And you, my dear,
are not a cockerel. You're only a cat."

So Kitten-Cat put her tail between her legs and crept back
to her mother. "Wake up!" she cried. "Wake up!"
I can't do anything. I'm only a cat!"

"Only a cat indeed!" Kitten-Cat's mother sprang to her feet.
"Then I think the time has come for you to follow me . . .

. . . first we'll climb a tree



. . . catch a mouse or two or three

. . . walk a tightrope and another

. . . move more silently than lizards

. . . get the lazy guard dog guarding

. . . take a nap where he can't reach us

. . . make quite sure no cream is wasted

. . . see as clear as day in darkness

. . . call a meeting in the clearing and announce
in purrs like thunder, ONLY A CAT CAN DO ALL THAT!"

But Kitten-Cat couldn't stay for the applause. She was already down at the river. "Because," she told the fish, "if a cat can do all that, surely a cat can . . .

. . . SWIM?"

Kitten-Cat`s mother was dozing
猫妈妈正在阳光下打着盹儿，
so Kitten-Cat played with her tail...and played with her tail...
小猫咪不想睡觉，在一边兴致勃勃地玩着自己的小尾巴，她玩呀玩……
and climbed on to the washing line to try some flying.
没多久，她就兴奋地爬上晾衣绳，试着像鸟儿一样飞起来。
“Whoops!” laughed the birds.
“诶唷！”鸟儿们笑着说，
“Hasn`t anyone told you? Cats can`t fly.”
“难道没有人告诉你吗？猫是不会飞的。”
So Kitten-Cat picked herself up, smoothed herself down and went to try some nut-cracking.
于是小猫咪站起来，平静了一会儿，又想去啃坚果。
“Oh dear, oh dear!” chuckled the squirrels.
“哎呀，天哪！”松鼠们咯咯地笑道。
“Haven`t you noticed? Cats can`t crack nuts.”
“难道你不知道吗？猫是啃不动坚果的。”
So Kitten-Cat put her nose in the air and slipped down to the stream to try some hopping.
于是小猫咪仰起鼻子在空气中闻了闻，接着跑到了小溪边，试着像青蛙一样跳起来。
“Silly billy!” croaked the frogs.
“笨猫！”青蛙们呱呱地叫着。
“Look at yourself! You`re a cat and cats can`t hop.”
“看看你自己！你可是一只猫，猫是不会像我们这样跳的。”
So Kitten-Cat shook the mud from her paws,
于是小猫咪只好甩掉爪上的泥巴，
and strolled over to the henhouse to try some crowing.
她慢悠悠地走到鸡窝，想试着像公鸡一样打鸣。
“Nonsense and ridiculous!” said the cockerel.
“真是太无知太好笑了！”公鸡在一旁笑着说。

“Cockerels crow, not cats.
“公鸡才打鸣，猫可不会！
And you, my dear, are not a cockerel. You`re only a cat.”
而你，亲爱的，可不是小公鸡，你只是一只猫呀。”
So Kitten-Cat put her tail between her legs and crept back to her mother.
于是小猫咪夹着尾巴垂头丧气地回到了妈妈身边。
“Wake up!” she cried. “Wake up!”
“醒醒呀！”她哭着对妈妈说，“醒醒呀！”
“I can`t do anything. I`m only a cat!”
“我什么都做不了，我只是一只猫！”
“Only a cat indeed!” Kitten-Cat`s mother sprang to her feet.
猫妈妈跳着起身说道：“是啊，你确实只是一只猫！”
“Then I think the time has come for you to follow me...
“现在我想是时候啦，你该跟我一起……（要去做什么呢？）
...first we`ll climb a tree
……首先，我们要去爬一棵树。
...catch a mouse or two or three
……然后，我们去抓老鼠，一只，两只，或者三只！
...walk a tightrope and another
……我们还可以在拉紧的绳索上走来走去，
...move more silently than lizards
……我们能比蜥蜴更安静地走路，
...get the lazy guard dog guarding
……我们可以叫醒懒惰的看门狗，
...take a nap where he can`t reach us
……然后，在他够不着的地方睡觉，

...make quite sure no cream is wasted
……我们可以舔干净罐子，保证一滴奶油都不浪费，
...see as clear as day in darkness
……我们可以在夜晚看得像白天一样清楚，
...call a meeting in the clearing and announce in purrs like thunder,
……还可以在空地上召集大家时，发出雷鸣般的呼叫声，
ONLY A CAT CAN DO ALL THAT!”
只有猫才能做到所有这些事哦！”猫妈妈自豪地说。
But Kitten-Cat couldn`t stay for the applause.
但是，小猫咪并没有理会大家的欢呼。
She was already down at the river.
不一会儿，她就已经到河边去啦。
“Because,” she told the fish, “if a cat can do all that, surely a cat can……SWIM?”
“因为（我在想），”她对河里的鱼儿说，“如果一只猫可以做这么多事，那肯定也会...游泳吧？”